

Word family: ****burden / burdens / burdened / burdening / burdensome / overburden / unburden****

****Base word:**** burden

****Forms:**** burdens, burdened, burdening

****Related forms:**** burdensome, overburden, overburdened, unburden

****Part of speech:**** noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...because it places an unfair ****burden**** on businesses..."

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****burden**** means a ****difficult responsibility, cost, demand, or disadvantage that someone has to carry or deal with****.

The restaurants are being forced to absorb costs and inconvenience created by people using their tables as unofficial classrooms.

****繁體中文： ** 負擔；使某人 / 機構承受額外成本、責任、壓力或困難的事物****

****中文翻譯： ****

> "...it places an unfair ****burden**** on businesses..."

「.....因為這會給商戶帶來不公平的****負擔****.....」

Here:

****burden on businesses = 商戶被迫承擔的額外成本、壓力和不便****

1. ****burden = heavy physical load (實體) — 重擔；負荷****

This is the original physical sense.

****Meaning:**** Something heavy that a person or animal carries.

Practice 1

> "The animal struggled under its heavy ****burden****."

「那隻動物背着沉重的****負荷 / 重擔****，走得很吃力。」

Practice 2

> “He put down his **burden** and rested.”

「他放下身上的**重擔**休息。」

burden = 必須攜帶、承受的沉重物件或重量

Modern general dictionaries still record this literal sense, although it is more formal/literary than **load** in ordinary conversation. ([劍橋詞典][1])

2. **burden** = difficult responsibility, problem, cost, or worry (負擔) — 負擔；重擔

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Something that creates substantial difficulty, work, responsibility, expense, worry, or pressure for someone.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The practice places an unfair **burden** on businesses.”

「這種做法給商戶造成不公平的**負擔**。」

Practice 4

> “Caring for everything alone became a heavy **burden**.”

「獨自處理所有事情成了沉重的**負擔**。」

Practice 5

> “The additional costs created a financial **burden** for the family.”

「額外開支給這個家庭造成了經濟**負擔**。」

burden = 某人必須承受的困難、責任、成本、壓力或憂慮

Common:

* heavy burden

* financial burden

* tax burden

* administrative burden

* burden of responsibility

- * burden on taxpayers
- * burden on businesses

This is the major modern figurative sense. ([劍橋詞典][1])

3. **burden** = responsibility that falls on someone (責任) — 責任 ; 重任

Sometimes **burden** specifically emphasizes who must carry responsibility.

Practice 6

> “The **burden** of caring for the children fell mainly on her.”

「照顧孩子的**責任重擔**主要落在她身上。」

Practice 7

> “Businesses should not carry the entire **burden**.”

「企業不應承擔全部**責任 / 負擔**。」

the burden falls on someone = 某人被迫承擔責任或代價

For strict counting, this belongs under Meaning 2 rather than becoming a new core sense.

4. **burden** = financial/economic cost imposed on someone (經濟) — 經濟負擔 ; 成本負擔

This is especially common in economic and policy language.

Practice 8

> “Higher interest rates increase the **burden** on borrowers.”

「較高利率增加了借款人的**經濟負擔**。」

Practice 9

> “The policy could reduce the tax **burden** on small businesses.”

「這項政策可能減輕小型企業的**稅務負擔**。」

Common compounds:

- * debt burden
- * tax burden
- * financial burden
- * cost burden

For the general database, these should remain under Meaning 2: the thing being carried is financial rather than physical.

5. **burden of proof** = responsibility to prove a claim (法律) — 舉證責任

This is an important legal construction.

Practice 10

> “The **burden of proof** lies with the prosecution.”

「**舉證責任**在控方。」

Practice 11

> “Who carries the **burden of proof**?”

「誰負有**舉證責任**？」

burden of proof = 在法律或論證中，有責任證明某項主張是真實的一方所承擔的責任

Cambridge defines it specifically as the responsibility for proving something. ([劍橋詞典][2])

This is a specialized fixed construction of the **responsibility burden** sense, not an unrelated new core meaning.

6. **burden of disease** = total health impact on a population (公共衛生) — 疾病負擔

In medicine, epidemiology, and public health, **burden** can mean the total impact of disease, injury, disability, or premature death on a population.

Practice 12

> “The study measured the **burden of disease** in older adults.”

「這項研究評估老年人口的**疾病負擔**。」

Practice 13

> “Air pollution contributes substantially to the health **burden**.”

「空氣污染對整體健康**負擔**有重大影響。」

WHO uses **burden of disease** as a quantified population-health concept involving mortality and disability; DALYs are one standard measure. ([世界衛生組織][3])

This is a highly established technical extension of:

> **something harmful that a population must bear**

7. **burden** = amount/extent of disease or abnormal material (醫學) — 病變負荷；疾病量

Clinical and biomedical language also uses **burden** for the amount or extent of something harmful in the body, for example:

- * tumour burden
- * viral burden
- * disease burden

繁體中文： **體內疾病、腫瘤或其他病理因素的總量 / 負荷**

This overlaps conceptually with Meaning 6, but the scale can be an individual patient rather than a whole population.

For core counting, I would keep medical **burden** under the broader abstract-load branch and flag it as domain-specific.

8. **burden** = verb: impose difficulty, responsibility, cost, or worry on someone (使負擔) — 加重……負擔；使承受

As a verb, **burden** means to give someone something difficult or unpleasant to deal with.

Practice 14

> “I don’t want to **burden** you with my problems.”

「我不想拿自己的問題來**增加你的負擔**。」

Practice 15

> “The new rules may **burden** small businesses with extra paperwork.”

「新規則可能會讓小型企業承擔更多文書工作，**加重其負擔**。」

burden someone with something = 讓某人承擔令人困難、麻煩、昂貴或擔憂的事情

This is a central modern verb meaning. ([劍橋詞典][1])

9. **burden** = verb: load physically (使負重) — 裝載重物；使負重

The verb can also retain the literal physical sense.

Practice 16

> “The animals were heavily **burdened** with supplies.”

「那些動物背着大量補給品，**負載很重**。」

burden something/someone = 把重物加在其身上，使其負重

For strict counting, this aligns with physical Meaning 1.

10. **burdened with/by** = weighed down by problems, debt, duties, etc. (承受) — 背負；受……
困擾

The participle **burdened** is extremely common.

Practice 17

> “The company is **burdened with** debt.”

「這家公司背負着沉重的債務**負擔**。」

Practice 18

> “She felt **burdened by** responsibility.”

「她感到被責任**壓得很沉重**。」

Common:

- * burdened with debt
- * burdened by responsibility
- * burdened with costs
- * burdened by expectations

This belongs to the abstract-load branch.

11. **beast of burden** = animal used to carry/pull loads (固定表達) — 役畜

Practice 19

> “Donkeys have long been used as beasts of **burden**.”

「驢長久以來都被當作**役畜**使用。」

beast of burden = 用來載重或拉動東西的動物，例如驢、牛等

Cambridge records this as an established expression. ([劍橋詞典][4])

12. **bear/carry the burden** = 承擔負擔 / 責任

Practice 20

> “Customers should not have to **bear the burden** of the company’s mistakes.”

「顧客不應被迫**承擔**公司的錯誤所造成的負擔。」

Practice 21

> “She carried the emotional **burden** for years.”

「她多年來一直背負着那份情感**重擔**。」

The physical metaphor remains transparent:

> carrying a heavy object → carrying a difficult responsibility/problem

13. **share the burden** = 分擔負擔

Practice 22

> “The costs should be shared so that one group does not carry the entire **burden**.”

「成本應該共同承擔，避免由一個群體承受全部**負擔**。」

14. **ease/lighten/reduce the burden** = 減輕負擔

Practice 23

> “Automation can reduce the administrative **burden**.”

「自動化可以減輕行政**負擔**。」

These are major collocations and especially useful for writing.

15. **burden** = overhead/indirect cost (會計) — 間接成本；製造費用

In accounting and manufacturing, **burden** can have a specialized meaning referring to indirect costs or overhead added to direct labour/material costs.

Examples:

- * factory burden
- * labour burden
- * burden rate
- * fully burdened cost

Practice 24

> “The calculation includes wages plus labour **burden**.”

「計算包括工資以及相關的**間接人工成本**。」

Accounting sources use **factory burden** as another term for manufacturing overhead, and **burden rate** for the rate at which indirect costs are allocated to labour or inventory.
([AccountingTools][5])

This is a genuine specialist sense and is particularly relevant because your passage later uses **overhead**.

16. **burden** = electrical load on an instrument transformer (電機工程) — 負載

In electrical engineering, especially with current transformers and voltage transformers, **burden** is the load presented by connected meters, relays, wiring, etc.

繁體中文： 儀用變壓器二次側所承受的負載

Schneider Electric explicitly describes connected relays and meters as **burdens** on instrument transformers. ([施耐德電氣產品資訊][6])

This is a real modern technical sense, but clearly specialist.

17. **burden** = ship's carrying capacity/cargo weight (航海，專門) — 載重能力；載貨量

In nautical terminology, **burden** can mean:

- * a ship's cargo-carrying capacity;
- * the weight of its cargo.

Collins records this as a nautical sense. ([Collins字典][7])

Database status: genuine but lower-priority specialist use.

18. **burden** = material charged into a furnace (冶金，專門) — 爐料

In metallurgy, **burden** can mean the mixture/material fed into a blast furnace or similar furnace.

繁體中文： 加入高爐 / 冶煉爐中的爐料

This is recorded as a specialist metallurgical sense. ([Collins字典][7])

Database status: specialist, low priority.

19. **burden** = refrain/chorus of a song (文學 / 歷史) — 副歌；反覆句

There is a separate historical/literary noun branch in which **burden** means a recurring refrain or chorus in a song.

Practice 25

> “The same **burden** returned at the end of each verse.”

「每段詩歌結尾都重複同一段**副歌 / 反覆句**。」

Modern dictionaries still record this branch, though it is uncommon in ordinary contemporary conversation. ([Collins字典][7])

Database status: recognize, lower-priority literary/historical.

20. **burden** = recurring/main theme of a speech, argument, message (正式 / 文學) — 主旨 ; 核心意思

From the refrain sense, **burden** can also mean a repeated or central theme.

Example:

> “The burden of his argument was that reform could not wait.”

「他的論點**主旨**是改革不能再拖延。」

Collins records **burden** as a repeated central idea or theme, e.g. the burden of a speech. ([Collins字典][7])

This is formal/literary and much less common than:

* main point

* theme

* gist

but it is genuine.

Related form: **burdensome**

Burdensome means causing substantial difficulty, expense, work, or responsibility.

Practice 26

> “The paperwork became increasingly **burdensome**.”

「這些文書工作變得越來越**繁重 / 造成很大負擔**。」

Practice 27

> “Small businesses complained about **burdensome** regulations.”

「小型企業投訴那些**負擔沉重 / 繁瑣的**規例。」

burdensome = 令人承擔過多工作、成本、責任或困難的

This is a useful family adjective.

Related form: **overburden**

Overburden means to give someone/something more work, responsibility, weight, or demand than they can comfortably handle.

Practice 28

> “The system is already **overburdened**.”

「這個系統已經**不堪重負**。」

Practice 29

> “We should not **overburden** staff with unnecessary paperwork.”

「我們不應用不必要的文書工作讓員工**負擔過重**。」

This is a very useful modern family extension.

Related form: **unburden**

Unburden can mean to relieve someone of a load or, more commonly figuratively, to tell someone your worries so that you feel emotionally lighter.

Practice 30

> “She **unburdened** herself to a close friend.”

「她向一位好友**傾訴心事**，讓自己卸下心理負擔。」

Common:

> ****unburden yourself to someone****

= 向某人傾吐煩惱 / 卸下心中重擔

This is a useful lexical-family extension.

Important distinction: ****burden vs load****

****load****

is the more general physical word for something carried or transported.

****burden****

often suggests the load is ****heavy, difficult, oppressive, or troublesome****.

> a truck carrying a load

> a person carrying a burden

Figuratively, ****burden**** is much more natural for responsibility and worry.

Important distinction: ****burden vs responsibility****

****responsibility****

is neutral:

> something you are responsible for.

****burden****

adds the judgment that the responsibility is:

* difficult

* heavy

* stressful

* costly

So:

> parental responsibility

is neutral.

> parental burden

suggests hardship and can sound negative.

Important distinction: **burden vs pressure**

pressure

emphasizes demands, stress, or force pushing someone.

burden

emphasizes something someone must **carry/cope with over time**.

> under pressure

> carry a burden

Important distinction: **burden vs cost**

cost

is the amount of money/resources required.

burden

is the negative impact of having to bear that cost.

> the cost is \$5,000

> the financial burden is substantial

Important distinction: **burden vs overhead**

This is especially relevant to your passage.

burden

in ordinary English:

> difficult cost/responsibility placed on someone.

****overhead****

in business:

> ongoing indirect operating expenses.

Your passage uses both ideas:

> an unfair ****burden**** on businesses

and later:

> restaurants absorb the hidden ****overhead****

In specialist accounting, however, ****burden**** itself can also mean allocated overhead/indirect cost.
([AccountingTools][5])

Important distinction: ****burden vs hardship****

****hardship****

means difficult conditions or suffering.

****burden****

means the responsibility/problem/cost that must be carried.

A burden can cause hardship.

Grammar note: ****burden on / burden to****

****a burden on someone/something****

> “The cost is a burden on small businesses.”

= 這項成本對小型企業構成負擔。

****a burden to someone****

> “He worries that he is a burden to his family.”

= 他擔心自己成為家人的負擔。

Both are natural, but typical contexts differ.

Grammar note: ****burden someone with something****

- > burden businesses with paperwork
- > burden families with extra costs
- > burden someone with your worries

This is the key verb pattern.

Countability note

In ordinary modern English, ****burden**** is generally countable:

- > a burden
- > several burdens
- > a heavy burden

But specialist compounds can function more abstractly:

- > disease burden
- > tax burden
- > labour burden

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****burden****
- * ****burdens****
- * ****burdened****
- * ****burdening****
- * ****burdensome****
- * ****overburden****
- * ****overburdened****
- * ****unburden****

Lower-priority/rare forms such as **burdener** or **burdenless** do not add enough practical learner value to retain.

A proper second-pass sweep also reveals established specialist uses in:

- * law
- * public health
- * accounting
- * electrical engineering
- * shipping
- * metallurgy

and a separate literary/historical **refrain/theme** branch. Those should be discovered and labelled, then filtered by usefulness rather than silently missed.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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burden — physical load	必須攜帶 / 承受的沉重實體重量；重擔、負荷
burden — problem/responsibility	令人承受大量困難、成本、責任、工作或憂慮的負擔
financial/tax burden	必須承擔的經濟、債務、稅務等壓力
burden of proof	有責任證明某項主張成立的一方所承擔的舉證責任
burden of disease	疾病、傷害、殘疾、死亡等對個人 / 人口造成的整體健康負擔
burden — verb	令某人承擔額外的困難、責任、成本或憂慮
burdened with/by	背負、承受或被某種問題 / 責任壓着
beast of burden	用來載重或拉東西的役畜
burden — accounting	分配到產品 / 人工上的間接成本、製造費用；專門
burden — electrical	儀用變壓器等所承受的電氣負載；專門
burden — nautical	船舶載重能力 / 載貨量；專門
burden — metallurgy	加入冶煉爐中的爐料；專門
burden — refrain	歌曲反覆出現的副歌 / 反覆句；文學、低頻
burden — central theme	講話、論述等反覆或主要的主旨；正式、低頻
burdensome	令人承擔繁重成本、工作或責任的
overburden	使負擔過重、不堪重負
unburden oneself	向別人傾吐心事，卸下心理負擔

For your original sentence

> “...because it places an unfair **burden** on businesses...”

The exact meaning is:

burden = 餐廳因這種做法而被迫額外承受的成本、營運壓力、座位損失和管理麻煩

So:

> **place an unfair burden on businesses**

= **給商戶造成不公平的負擔 / 迫使商戶承擔不應由它們承擔的代價**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful general core meanings** for **burden**:

1. **literal heavy load**
2. **figurative difficult responsibility, cost, worry, obligation, or hardship**
3. **verb — load or trouble someone/something with such a burden**

Then I would preserve several **established domain branches** without pretending they are ordinary everyday meanings:

- * **burden of proof** — legal
- * **disease burden** — public health/medicine
- * **accounting burden** — overhead/indirect cost
- * **electrical burden** — technical load
- * **ship's burden** — nautical carrying capacity
- * **furnace burden** — metallurgy

And I would retain **burden = refrain/main theme** as a genuine but lower-priority literary/historical branch.

[1]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/burden?utm_source=chatgpt.com

"BURDEN | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"

[2]: [https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/burden-of-proof?](https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/burden-of-proof?utm_source=chatgpt.com)

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[3]: https://www.who.int/news-room/questions-and-answers/item/environmental-health-estimations-of-attributable-burden-of-disease-due-to-a-risk-factor?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Environmental health: Estimations of attributable burden of disease due to a risk factor"

[4]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/beast-of-burden?utm_source=chatgpt.com

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[5]: https://www.accountingtools.com/articles/factory-burden?utm_source=chatgpt.com "Factory burden definition — AccountingTools"

[6]: [https://www.productinfo.schneider-](https://www.productinfo.schneider-electric.com/0100db2301_elecdistfunddesignguide/0100db2301-electrical-distribution-fundamentals-design-guide/English/0100DB2301%20Electrical%20Distribution%20Fundamentals%20Design%20Guide%20%28bookmap%29.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com)

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[7]: https://www.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/english/burden?utm_source=chatgpt.com

"BURDEN definition and meaning | Collins English Dictionary"